



Sharing Wi-Fi DATA Via BLUETOOTH

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Tethering, or phone-as-modem (PAM), is the process of sharing of a mobile device's Internet connection with another device, say, a cellphone or computer. Bluetooth tethering is one of the ways of sharing the wireless connection of an Android device with another device using Bluetooth. Say, you are using mobile data, and someone wants to use your data as well but you do not want to disclose the password. What would you do in that case? The answer is Bluetooth tethering, which is available on Android version 2.2 and above.

The phone that has data or is connected to Wi-Fi is referred to as Phone 1 (XT1068), and the phone that needs to access Phone 1's data via Bluetooth is referred to as Phone 2 (LS-5502).

Bluetooth tethering on phone

Steps for Bluetooth tethering on phone are as follows:

1. Turn on Bluetooth on both the phones. Open Bluetooth settings and keep both devices as Discoverable. You can do this via Settings→Bluetooth→Turn on. Keep this screen open (Fig. 1).
2. Pair the two devices. When Phone 1 is discovered by Phone 2, and vice-versa, a Bluetooth pairing code will ask for confirmation on both devices. Tap on Pair (Fig. 2).
3. Turn on Bluetooth tethering in Phone 1 from Settings→More→Tethering & Mobile Hotspot→Turn on Bluetooth tethering (Fig. 3).
4. Open Bluetooth settings (mentioned in Step 1) on both phones and keep them Discoverable. Tap on

Phone 2 name in Phone 1 to allow it to use data via Bluetooth tethering (Fig. 4).

5. Since Phone 2 is connected to Phone 1 via Bluetooth tethering, it can now access Internet.

This was tried on Moto G (2nd Gen) having Android 6.0 as Phone 1 and LYF Wind 3 having Android 5.1.1 as Phone 2, at the author's end. For testing at EFY Labs, Redmi 4 as Phone 1 and HTC U11 as Phone 2 were used.

Bluetooth tethering on laptop

Bluetooth tethering can also be done on a laptop in case Ethernet or Wi-Fi is not available. Steps are as follows:

1. Turn on Bluetooth in the cellphone and laptop. Pair the two devices. When these are discovered by each other, tap on laptop's name in the

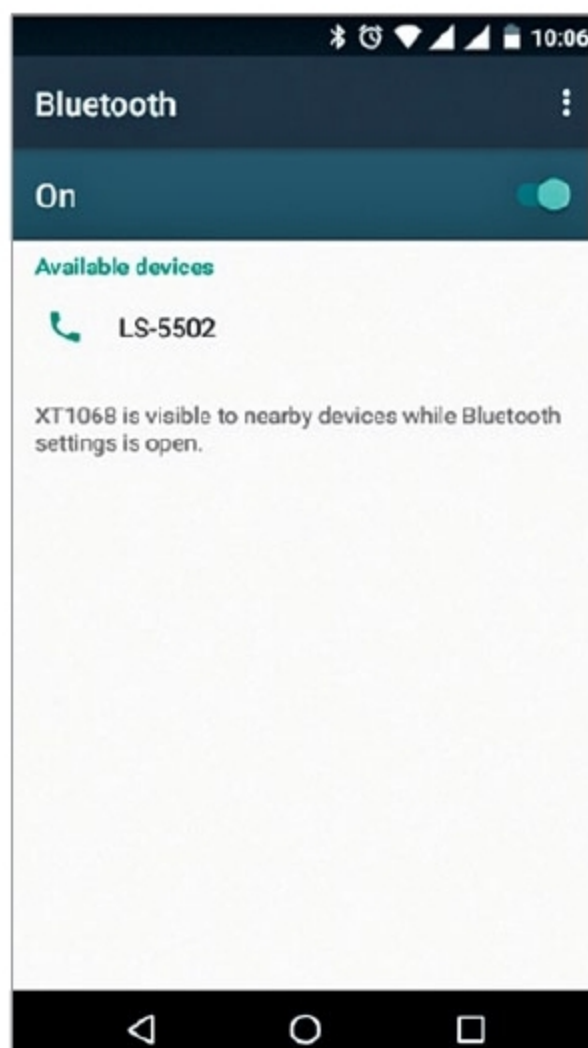


Fig. 1: Turning on Bluetooth

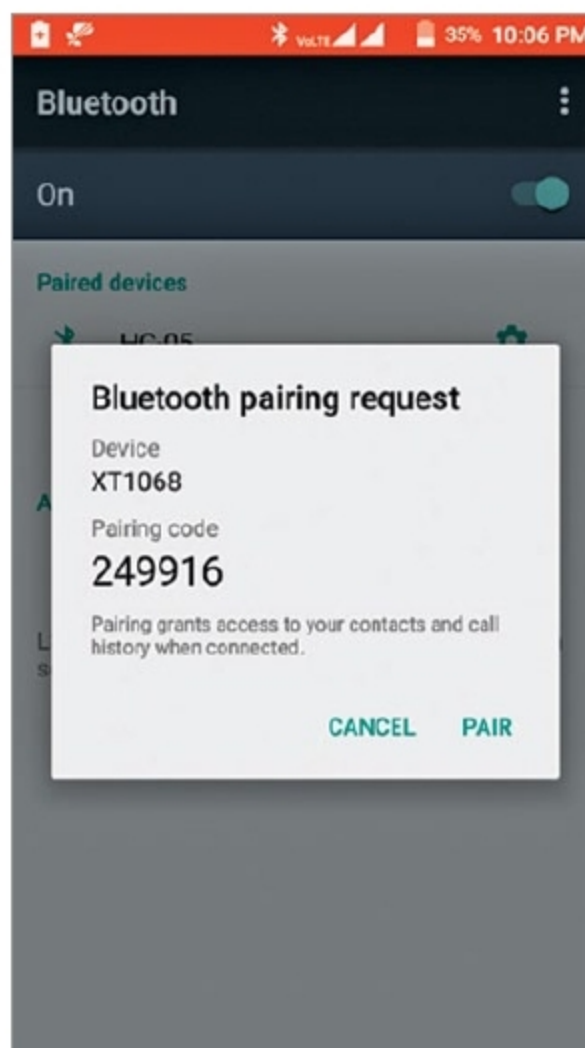


Fig. 2: Sending Bluetooth pairing request

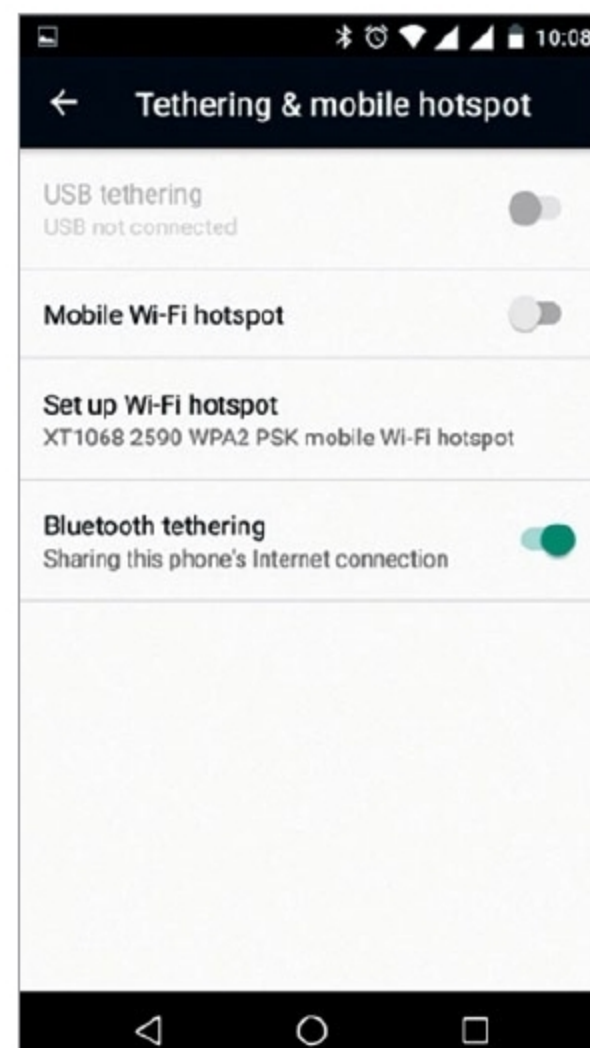


Fig. 3: Turning on Bluetooth tethering in Phone 1